SB MOBILE · BYOD ALT BUY FLOW · UX RESEARCH

Small Business BYOD Phase 2 Readout

Unmoderated usability test



October 2026

UX RESEARCH · CONFIDENTIAL · UserTesting

Spectrum

Why we re-tested the BYOD flow

Phase 1 learnings drove a revised prototype; Phase 2 re-tests to confirm usability and comprehension.

WHY PHASE 2

In earlier User Testing, small-business customers found line-by-line BYOD setup tedious and wanted to apply the same phone and plan to all lines at once.

Phase 1 found adding devices and plans easy, a preference for an early “apply to all” control, and some confusion over the 15-digit IMEI.

UX revised the prototype to address these learnings.

RESEARCH OBJECTIVES AND METHOD

Objective 1	Gauge overall appeal and ease of use of the new SB BYOD buyflow end to end.
Objective 2	Identify friction and points of confusion across the BYOD process, including unclear language.
Objective 3	Understand how users interact with the mass-applier and whether it matches their mental model.
Method	6 unmoderated desktop sessions, Oct 21-26, 2026 Task: bring 5 owned phones (4 Apple, 1 Samsung), Business Unlimited on all lines, new number per line. One phone was intentionally incompatible via a supplied IMEI of all zeros.

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Who we heard from

All 6 are U.S. small-business owners or co-owners who:

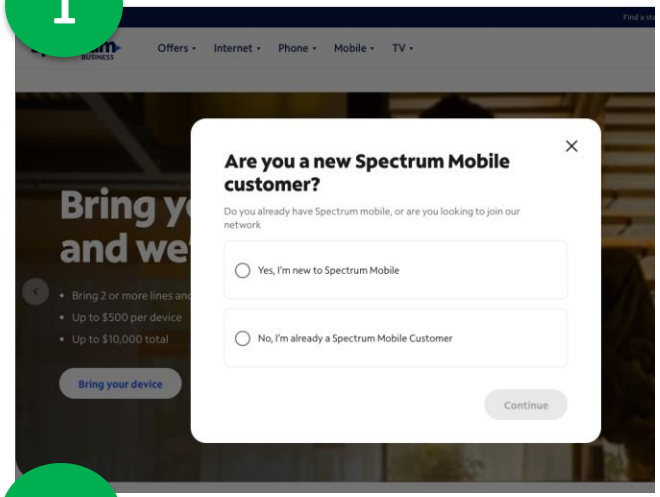
- are the primary decision-maker for internet and mobile purchases
- are shopping, or plan to shop, for a new mobile provider within 12 months
- are open to BYOD
- completed the test on a computer

Small sample; findings are directional.

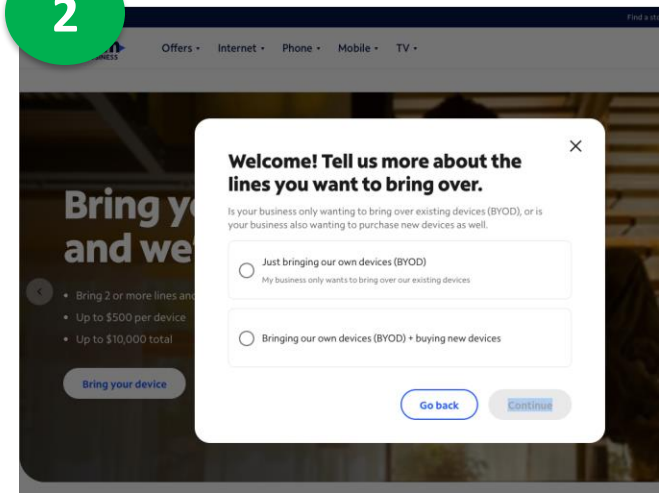
Spectrum

Prototype

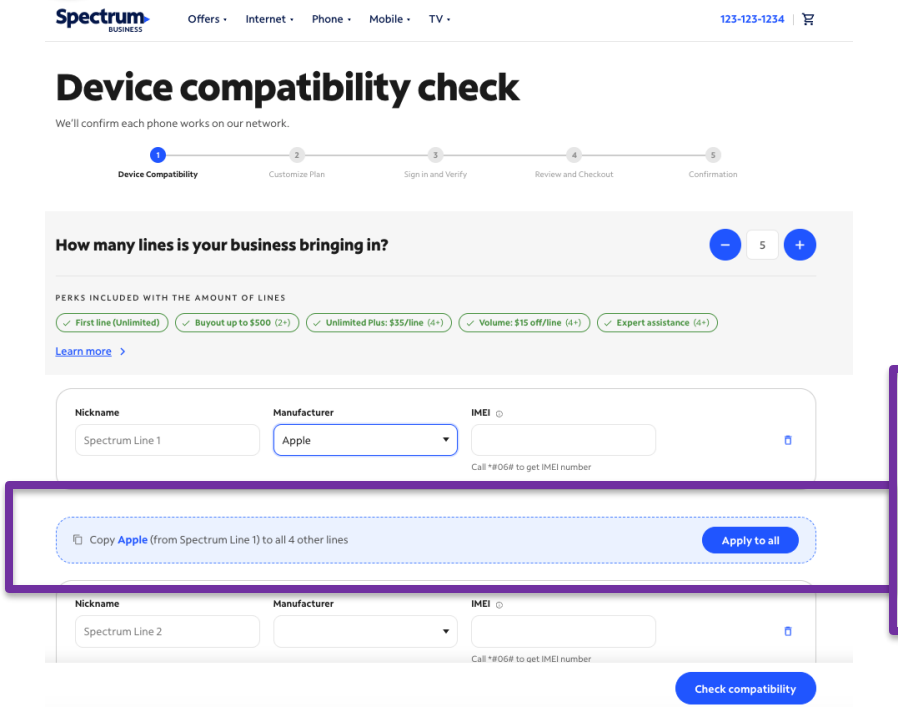
1



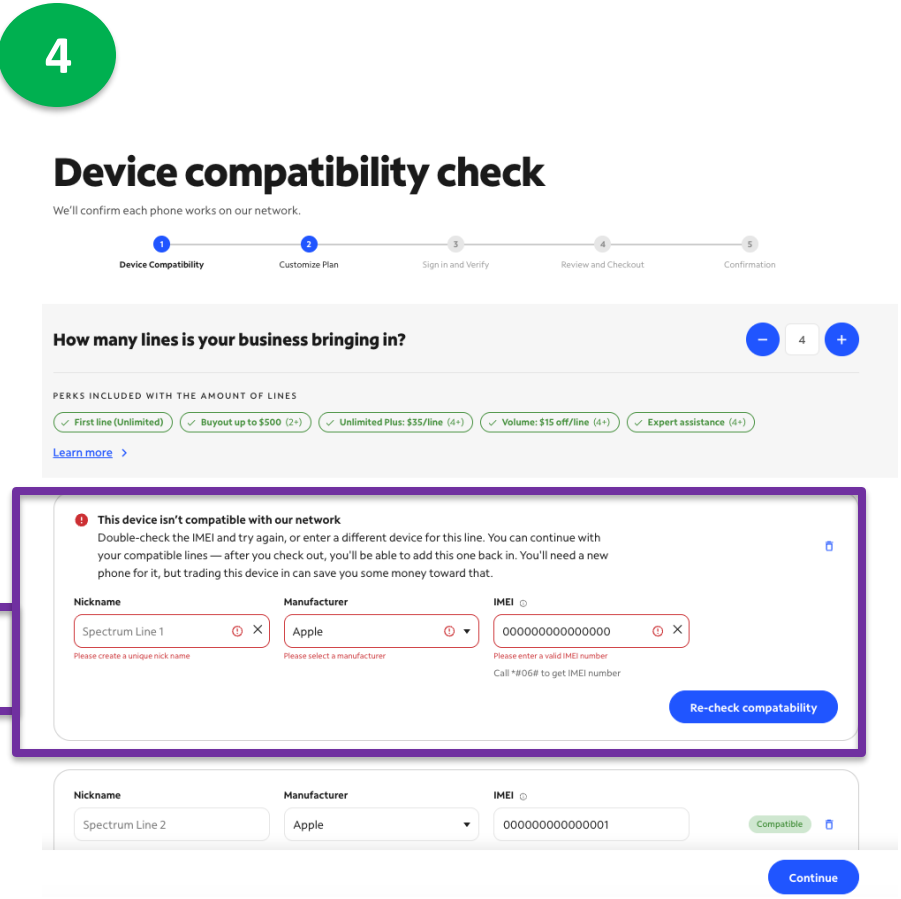
2



3



4



Spectrum

BYOD BUYFLOW

Prototype

5

Customize each line

Choose a data plan, decide whether to keep your number or get a new number, and add the optional Device Protection Plan. Apply to several lines at once if they match.



Data plan pricing

ANYTIME UPGRADE

Business Unlimited Plus
~~$50/mo~~
$35/mo

- Unlimited talk, text, and data
- No fee for mobile hotspot data
- International texting from the US and while abroad
- Roaming in 215+ destinations including Canada & Mexico
- Exclusive Anytime Upgrade access
- No long term contracts required
- 2,000 monthly international long distance minutes to Canada & Mexico

After 100GB and 50GB of mobile hotspot data, the network may deliver slower speeds due to high demand.

Business Unlimited
~~$40/mo~~
$25/mo

- Unlimited talk, text and data
- No fees for mobile hotspot data
- International texting from the US and while abroad
- No long term contracts required
- 2,000 monthly international long distance minutes to Canada & Mexico

After 30GB and 10GB of mobile hotspot data, the network may deliver slower speeds due to high demand.

Spectrum Line 2 000000000000001 — $25/mo

Data Plan: Business Unlimited | Phone Number: Assign a new number | Protection Plan Optional

Delete

Copy **Business Unlimited & assign new number** (from Spectrum Line 2) to all 2 other lines — Apply to all

Spectrum Line 3 000000000000002 — $25/mo

Data Plan: Business Unlimited | Phone Number: Assign a new number | Protection Plan Optional

Delete

Spectrum Line 4 000000000000003 — $25/mo

Data Plan: Business Unlimited | Phone Number: Assign a new number | Protection Plan Optional

Delete

+ Add another line

Spectrum Line 1 isn't shown here — it's not compatible, but it's saved. You'll pick a new device after checkout.

Lorem ipsum disclaimerLorem ipsum disclaimerLorem ipsum disclaimerLorem ipsum disclaimerLorem ipsum disclaimerLorem ipsum disclaimerLorem ipsum disclaimerLorem ipsum disclaimerLorem ipsum disclaimerLorem ipsum disclaimer

$75/mo — Continue

6



Are you a Spectrum Customer?

Sign in to continue. If you're new to Spectrum Mobile, please note that Internet is required to purchase Mobile.

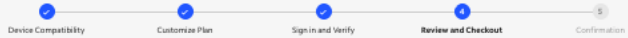
Yes, sign in | No, shop internet

7

Spectrum — $75.00/mo — Total due today $36.00

Shopping cart

Need help? Call 855-839-4246



Spectrum Line 2
New number assigned at activation
Apple device — bring your own, IMEI 000000000000001

Due today $12.00 | Monthly payment $25.00/mo

Device payment	$0.00
Plan Business Unlimited	$25.00
One-time activation fee	$12.00

Spectrum Line 3
New number assigned at activation
Apple device — bring your own, IMEI 000000000000002

Due today $12.00 | Monthly payment $25.00/mo

Device payment	$0.00
Plan Business Unlimited	$25.00
One-time activation fee	$12.00

Spectrum Line 4
New number assigned at activation
Apple device — bring your own, IMEI 000000000000003

Due today $12.00 | Monthly payment $25.00/mo

Device payment	$0.00
Plan Business Unlimited	$25.00
One-time activation fee	$12.00

Spectrum Line 1 isn't shown here — it's not compatible, but it's saved. You'll pick a new device after checkout.

Begin checkout

8

Personal | Business — Find a store | Contact us | My Account

Spectrum BUSINESS — $75.00/mo — Total Due Today $36.00

Checkout

Need help? Call 855-839-4246



After you checkout
You'll be able to add back **Spectrum Line 1**.

Contact info

Business Name: Joe's Pizza

First Name | Last Name

Mobile summary

Edit

Spectrum Line 2 — Apple device | IMEI 000000000000001	$25.00/mo
Spectrum Line 3 — Apple device | IMEI 000000000000002	$25.00/mo
Spectrum Line 4 — Apple device | IMEI 000000000000003	$25.00/mo

10

Personal | Business — Find a Store | Contact Us | My Account

Spectrum BUSINESS — Offers — Internet — Phone — Mobile — TV — 123-123-1234

Thank you for your order

We've sent a confirmation email to SARAHSMITH@EMAIL.COM



We didn't forget about Spectrum Line 1

That device couldn't be activated on our network, so that line is on hold. Pick whichever works for you.

Buy a new phone | Trade-in & buy a new phone

The prototype design reads as simple and clear

All made unprompted positive remarks about how simple, clear, or seamless the prototype felt.

OVERALL IMPRESSION

6 of 6

described the flow or its pages as simple, straightforward, clear, or seamless

“it was a lot simpler than I thought it would be” (P2)

“I felt like this was a pleasant experience overall.” (P1)

“It looks like a simple page, very easy to...” (P3)

IN THEIR WORDS

Simple	*“It’s a very simple page.” (P3)* *“it is simple, the process is simple, it’s not complicated.” (P4)*
Clear	*“Everything looks very clear.” (P2)* *“I was understanding everything perfectly clear” (P6)*
User friendly	*“The page seems pretty user friendly, I would say. It’s not overly confusing” (P1)*
Seamless	*“It’s a pretty seamless process... I don’t feel overwhelmed by the process” (P1)* *“This did such an incredible, like, seamless job” (P2)*
Appealing	*“Very simple, very easy, very appealing.” (P3)*

Directional: unprompted comments from 6 participants; no task asked about visual design.

Spectrum

IMEI is well understood

All 6 correctly described what an IMEI is and where to find it. Tracking habits vary.

COMPREHENSION

6 of 6

described an IMEI and where to find it (settings / about), an improvement on Phase 1 confusion

“It’s almost like a VIN number for the phone... only that number for that one phone.” (P5)

“I can press star pound zero six pound [called out in prototype], or I can always get those from the device settings.” (P3)

HOW PARTICIPANTS TRACK IMEIs

Spreadsheet	*“We keep track of them based on a spreadsheet” (P1)*
	“I use a spreadsheet to keep track of all of the phones, the purchase dates, and all the basic information” (P3)
Dashboard	*“We have a little dashboard that shows all the phones with that information” (P4)*
Not tracked	*“Once they’ve been registered and activated, it’s kind of a forgotten detail.” (P5)*
	“We don’t necessarily keep track of the IMEI numbers... all that information’s already in the phone so we just keep that in the phone and look for it when we need to.” (P6)
Ask	*“I would think like a tip or tool on how to find the correct IMEI number... if this is the wrong number, here’s some ideas to go find the right one.” (P2)*

Several users do not keep IMEIs handy; evidence on the *#06# helper is limited.

Severity rating = frequency x impact. Levels used: Major, Minor, and Positive (a strength to protect).

Spectrum

The mass-applier is a standout success

Praised by 5 of 6. One entered phones manually, then used it for plans.

MASS-APPLIER

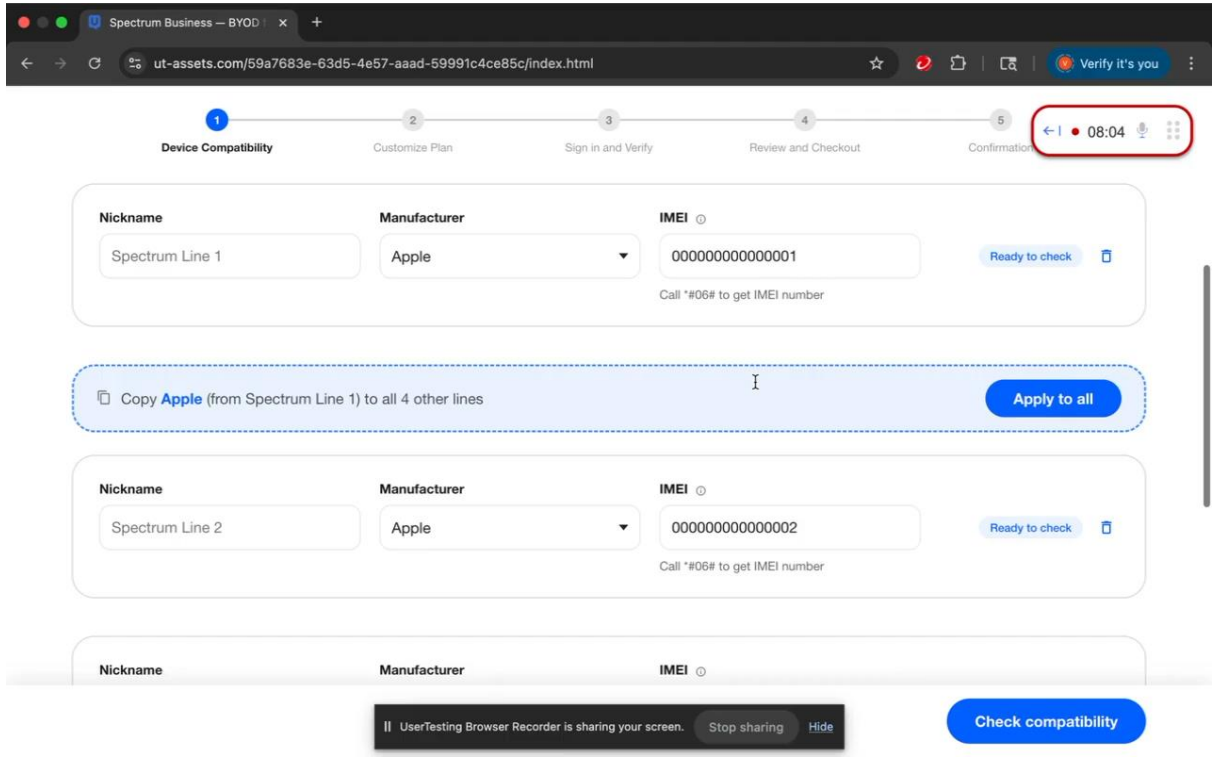
5 of 6

praised “apply to all”; it matched their mental model and saved time

“I love that I could just copy and paste, like apply to all, that was actually really convenient and very time saving.” (P2)

“As soon as I picked the plan for the first line, a blue button came up and it allowed me to copy it to all the other lines.” (P3)

“Once I found the manufacturer it allowed me to see copy Apple to all four other lines… so I didn’t have to repeat the same process.” (P6)



The mass-applier matched users’ mental model.

Severity rating = frequency x impact. Levels used: Major, Minor, and Positive (a strength to protect).

Spectrum

Compatibility messaging reads clearly

Participants read the incompatible-line message, and the post-order next steps, correctly.

COMPREHENSION

6 of 6

understood the incompatible-line message and knew what to do next

“This device isn’t compatible with our network. Double check the IMEI... you can continue with your compatible lines. After you check out, you’ll be able to add this one back in.” (P1)

WHAT PARTICIPANTS UNDERSTOOD

Compatible result	4 of 6 saw a clean compatible result and read it correctly.
Incompatible line	The message told them to continue with their compatible lines and add the other phone back after checkout. P1 read it back accurately.

The wording works; the risk is that none expected a phone to be incompatible (next slide).

Severity rating = frequency x impact. Levels used: Major, Minor, and Positive (a strength to protect).

Spectrum

No one expected a phone to be incompatible

Half treated the flag as a typo or system error.

P3 · CHANGED THE IMEI

"That was the IMEI that I was told to put in... I went ahead and changed the IMEI to match the rest... instead of a zero at the end, I added a number four." (P3)

P5 · READ IT AS AN ERROR

"It seemed more like an informational error than an actual compatibility error... the IMEI was put in wrong, who knows... especially when all of the other phones were the exact same models." (P5)

P6 · CHANGED THE DIGIT

"If I found it was not working, I just changed one of the numbers from zero to four... once I changed it, it became compatible and I went on." (P6)

CAVEATS

The test design likely shaped this. Participants were told to enter specific IMEIs (one all zeros), the study was unmoderated so we could not ask why they assumed a typo, and the phones were hypothetical, so the stakes felt low. A real, non-forced incompatibility is needed to confirm.

Directional only (test-induced). The design response is Recommendation 3 on slide 16.

Severity rating = frequency x impact. Levels used: Major, Minor, and Positive (a strength to protect).

Spectrum

Plan info was enough

One wanted to click through for more detail, but the links were not active in the prototype.

PLAN INFORMATION

6 of 6

said the on-page plan information was enough to make a decision

“I felt like it did a really good job and actually showing me the difference between the two was really helpful.” (P2)

WHAT WORKED, WHAT FELL SHORT

What worked	The side-by-side comparison of Business Unlimited vs. Unlimited Plus was clear, addressing the Phase 1 request to explain the plan difference before choosing.
P1	*“If the links were working, then yes… without being able to click on it, I have limited option.” (P1)* *“I don’t know specifically what [Anytime Upgrade] entails here without being able to click on it, so I can’t really factor that in.” (P1)* P1 also suggested adding network-speed information.

The click-through gap is largely a prototype artifact (links were stubbed).

Severity rating = frequency x impact. Levels used: Major, Minor, and Positive (a strength to protect).

Spectrum

Checkout is clear; one gap on taxes and fees

5 of 6 said nothing would stop them from ordering.

CHECKOUT

5 of 6

said nothing would stop them from ordering

"Nothing is confusing. It's showing me the plan details as well as the device details." (P3)

ONE SPECIFIC GAP

Taxes and fees	One respondent wanted clarity on whether taxes and fees are included in the estimated monthly charge: *"I don't see anything about taxes and fees" (P3)*
See also	The one participant who said something would stop them (P5) was reacting to the incompatible line, covered in Finding 6.

Checkout was not a barrier; the only gap was P3 not seeing taxes and fees addressed.

Severity rating = frequency x impact. Levels used: Major, Minor, and Positive (a strength to protect).

Spectrum

The incompatible line is easy to miss

Most participants did not notice the bottom-of-page note about the incompatible line without being prompted.

NOTICED UNPROMPTED

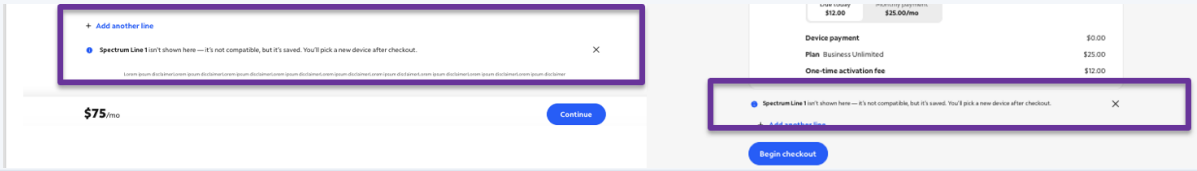
2 of 6

saw the note on their own (P1, P2)

"Spectrum Line four isn't shown here. It is not compatible, but it is saved. You'll pick a new device after checkout... so we are missing one here... the total without Spectrum line four." (P1)

NOTICED VS. NOT NOTICED

P2 noticed	"The bottom of the page said there was still the IMEI number with the zeros at the end... it's not compatible yet. But that's okay, I can keep doing everything else and move forward." (P2)
P3, P4	Both read "bottom of the page" as the "add another line" control and the per-month total.
P5	"I didn't notice anything really. Um, but now that I'm looking, I see [the line]'s not shown here because it's not compatible, but it is saved and there's the option to pick a new device after checkout." (P5)
P6	"At the bottom of the page I didn't really notice anything... I was just focused on entering information for the five phones that I already have." (P6)



The note works for those who see it, but unprompted noticeability is low; one noted the total excludes the missing line.

Severity rating = frequency x impact. Levels used: Major, Minor, and Positive (a strength to protect).

Spectrum

Some want to fix the phone before checkout

2 of 6 named handling the incompatible line before checkout as their single change, and one raised a concern

P5 · KEEP IT INSIDE CHECKOUT

"I would integrate the adjustment for the incompatible phone in the checkout process, not after it. I want to see everything in one clear picture and I don't want multiple transactions." (P5)

"I just can't imagine most people want to work backwards from what they feel like they've already completed." (P5)

In other words: P5 sees checkout as the finish line, so fixing the incompatible phone afterward feels like going back.

P1 · RESOLVE IT FIRST, AND SEE THE COST

"I feel like sometimes you may want to actually work on that one before checking out." (P1)

Cost visibility: Deferring hides part of the true cost, because the replacement is not reflected in the checkout total. P1 noted it adds up for businesses with many lines.

"Now that's another line of expense that we didn't account for yet in this total that we saw... and if you have a lot of these, that would come across as an important item to be aware of in terms of an expense." (P1)

P5 · THE RISK OF DEFERRING

"...worst case scenario... we've just now bought four lines and traded in four phones and started four new numbers that we can't even use with the other phone." (P5)

OTHER VIEW · P2

"So it's nice that I can come back and do it later." (P2)

OTHER VIEW · P6

"If it means that I get the order placed through and it's already there, it should be fine." (P6)

Timing is a preference for some, but the hidden cost applies to everyone.

Severity rating = frequency x impact. Levels used: Major, Minor, and Positive (a strength to protect).

Spectrum

A more prominent incompatible-line callout

PROMINENCE OF THE CALLOUT AT CHECKOUT

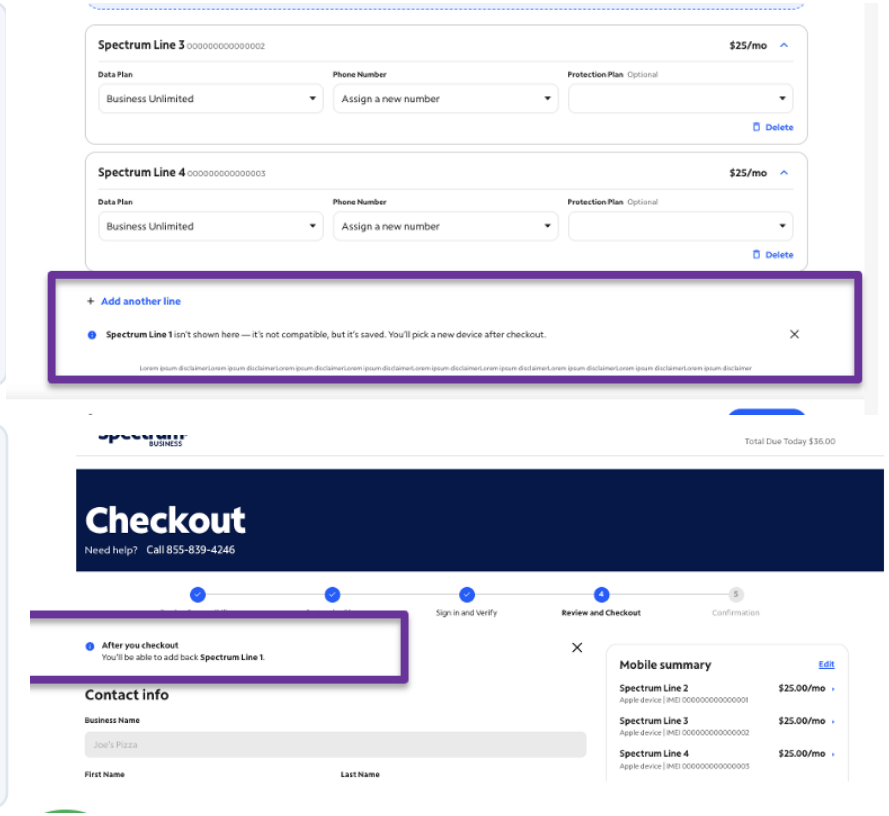
One requested the message to be visually bigger, repeating the point twice, and called the information crucial:

"I wish this comes across in bigger font or something more prominent" (P1); "maybe that should be a little bit more prominent so that you don't forget this one." (P1); "That's crucial information that needs to be displayed." (P1)

PLACEMENT, NOT JUST SIZE

P2 expected the callout in the right-hand order summary alongside the other lines, though found it acceptable where it appeared:

"I was expecting to see it over on the right by all the lines, but, um, it's not bad right here too." (P2)



Directional only (one participant each). Both points are folded into Recommendation 1 on slide 16.

Severity rating = frequency x impact. Levels used: Major, Minor, and Positive (a strength to protect).

Spectrum

Easy and appealing; fix the incompatible line

Phase 2 tested the revised SB BYOD alt buy flow end to end with 6 small-business decision-makers (N = 6).

4.8 / 5

Ease of adding devices, setting up lines, and overall process (each mean, N = 6)

4.5 / 5

Appeal of this way of bringing your own phones; four rated 5, two rated 4

2 of 6

noticed the bottom-of-page incompatible-line note without being prompted

WHAT WORKED

Design	All 6 called the flow simple, clear, or seamless.
Mass-applier	The most-praised feature (5 of 6).
Plan info	6 of 6 said it was enough to decide.
Also worked	IMEI understood by all 6; checkout clear to 5 of 6.

FIX FIRST

Incompatible line	Easy to miss (2 of 6 noticed it); resolving it after checkout drew objections; its cost is missing from the checkout total (P1).
Expectations	None expected a phone to be incompatible; 3 of 6 treated the flag as a typo.
Smaller gaps	Line-count selector overlooked, taxes and fees not addressed, “learn more” links inactive.

Directional only: 6 unmoderated desktop sessions; ratings cluster near the ceiling.

Spectrum

Fix the incompatible line first

Priority reflects the severity of the supporting finding.

01

P0 - HIGH

Make the incompatible line hard to miss

- Make the incompatible-line note far more prominent before/at checkout and consider also showing it in the right-hand order summary next to the other lines
- Surface the likely added cost for that line so the displayed total is not misleading
- Ideally, let users resolve (or stage) the incompatible line before checkout rather than only after.

02

P1 - MED

Make “apply to all” obvious for new numbers

Make the “apply to all” affordance for the new-number choice as visually obvious as the data-plan one (since the same mass applier is used)

03

P1 - MED

Set the expectation that incompatibility is real

Explain briefly why a phone can be incompatible and point to a way to verify or get help, so users do not assume a typo and retry.

Understand % or prospects that have had an incompatible line in the buyflow

Priority (P0 high, P1 medium, P2 low) reflects severity (frequency x impact) of the supporting finding.

Spectrum

Then the smaller clarifications

Priority reflects the severity of the supporting finding.

04 P2 - LOW

Add an inline IMEI helper

Add an inline IMEI helper/tip (what it is, how to find it, and *#06#), shown especially when an entry fails. Validate whether the existing *#06# callout is noticed.

05 P2 - LOW

State taxes and fees at checkout

Clarify on checkout whether taxes/fees are included in the estimated monthly charge.

Priority (P0 high, P1 medium, P2 low) reflects severity (frequency x impact) of the supporting finding.

Spectrum

Rating scales

1 = very difficult / unappealing, 5 = very easy / appealing. Source: UserTesting metrics export (N = 6).

Measure (Task)	Mean	Median	Distribution (P1-P6)
Ease of adding devices (T13)	4.83	5	4, 5, 5, 5, 5, 5
Ease of setting up lines (T20)	4.83	5	4, 5, 5, 5, 5, 5
Overall ease of process (T27)	4.83	5	4, 5, 5, 5, 5, 5
Appeal of BYOD approach (T28)	4.50	4.5	4, 5, 5, 5, 4, 4

In every rating, P1 is the low scorer (4); on appeal, P5 and P6 also gave 4.